

DL Alvarez

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Working with historical narratives in various mediums—drawing, film, sculpture, text, ephemera, and organizational systems—Alvarez was schooled in Theater Craft at Gallaudet University, the Oregon Shakespeare Theater and Deaf West Theater. They gravitate towards collaborative, community building processes.

FEATURE EXHIBITIONS (solo and two person* shows, partial list)

2025	<i>Dormagory</i>	GGLA (Guerrero Gallery) LA
2024	<i>Lug</i>	Right Window, SF
2020	<i>Jet</i>	StudiOffice, SF
2015	* <i>The Children's Hour</i> [w/J.V. Bond]	2nd floor projects, SF
2014	* <i>DL Alvarez and Eileen Maxson</i>	Artadia Gallery, NY
2013	<i>The Unforgiving Minute</i>	Derek Eller Gallery, NY
2012	<i>Matrix 243</i>	Berkeley Art Museum
2011	<i>Night of Lead</i>	Galeria Casado Santapau, Madrid
2009	<i>Dusty Hayes</i>	2nd floor projects, SF
2008	<i>Dead Leaves</i>	Galeria Casado Santapau, Madrid
2007	<i>Parents' Day</i>	Derek Eller Gallery, NY
	* <i>DIG</i> [w/Wayne Smith]	Derek Eller Gallery, NY
2006	* <i>Casper</i> [w/Matthew Lutz-Kinoy]	Arratia Beer, Berlin.
2005	<i>rise</i>	Derek Eller Gallery, NY
	<i>Ise</i>	Glue, Berlin
2004	* <i>Ordinary Traveler</i>	Laura Mars Group, Berlin
	<i>Beausoleil</i>	Derek Eller Gallery, NY
2003	* <i>It's a Wonderful Life</i> [w/G. Rattke]	NGBK, Berlin
	<i>windstöße</i>	Kunsthau, Dresden
2002	* <i>Cottage Industry</i> [w/G. Rattke]	Berlinische Galerie, Berlin
	<i>The Road to Hell Less Traveled</i>	Derek Eller Gallery, NY
2000	<i>Sculpture Garden</i>	Derek Eller Gallery, NY
1999	<i>Chorus</i>	John Berggruen Gallery, SF
1998	<i>Knights Gathering Flowers</i>	Derek Eller Gallery, NY
	<i>Dust</i>	Th.E, Naples
1997	* <i>DL Alvarez and Ruby Neri</i>	New Langton Arts, SF
1996	* <i>SECA Award</i>	SFMOMA
	<i>Dandelion</i>	Jack Hanley Gallery, SF CA

GROUP EXHIBITIONS

2024	<i>House Party</i>	GGLA (Guerrero Gallery) LA
	<i>Toadstools</i>	Helen's Costume, Portland OR
	<i>Spectral Transmissions</i>	Camden International Film Fest, Maine
	<i>First Look</i>	Museum of the Moving Image, NY
	<i>Contigo</i>	GGLA (Guerrero Gallery) LA
	<i>Spectral Transmissions</i>	North Carolina Museum of Art
2023	<i>Spectral Transmissions</i>	IDFA, Amsterdam
	<i>Abstract Adjacent</i>	Mon Dieu, LA
	<i>Mind</i>	GGLA (Guerrero Gallery) LA

2022	<i>The Last Waltz</i>	Delaplane, SF
2021	<i>Bazaar</i>	Helen's Costume, Portland OR
	<i>Ghosts of Future Pasts</i>	Portland International Film Festival
	<i>The Bumpy Road</i>	Helen's Costume, Portland OR
2020	<i>The Party's Over</i>	Grant Wahlquist Gallery, Maine
	<i>The de Young Open</i>	de Young Museum, SF
	<i>Peace</i>	Delaplane, SF
	<i>Coloring</i>	Exile, Vienna
2019	<i>Strange</i>	Berkeley Art Museum
	<i>Queer California: Untold Stories</i>	Oakland Museum of California
	<i>Tales of the City</i>	SF Arts Commission Gallery
	<i>Ties, Tales, and Traces</i>	KW Institute for Contemporary Art
2018	<i>Way Bay</i>	Berkeley Art Museum
	<i>Fruit</i>	Palazzo Re Enzo, Bolonga, Italy
2017	<i>From the Collection: 1980 to Today</i>	SFMOMA
2016	<i>Tight Ass</i>	CB1, LA
	<i>Subject To Capital</i>	Abrons Arts Center, NY
2015	<i>The Visitor Owl</i>	SFMOMA off site projects
	<i>FLÖHE</i>	der Volkspark Galerie, Berlin
2014	<i>Visiting Artists</i>	Artadia Gallery, NY
	<i>Ephemera As Evidence</i>	La Mama Galleria, NY
2013	<i>Ballet of Heads</i>	Berkeley Art Museum
	<i>Snapshot Poetics Now</i>	Contemporary Jewish Museum, SF
	<i>Everything Out There</i>	Diego Rivera Gallery, SF
2012	<i>Stage Presence</i>	SFMOMA
	<i>Drawn from Photography</i>	DePaul University Art Museum, Chicago
	<i>Up Against It</i>	Munch, NY
	<i>Panorama</i>	SFMOMA
	<i>Joe/Brains/Lamar</i>	CCS Bard Library and Archives, NY
2011	<i>SECA Anniversary Exhibition</i>	SFMOMA
	<i>The Air We Breathe</i>	SFMOMA
	<i>Outer Space From an Aquarium</i>	Famous Accountants, NY
	<i>Weaklings</i> , curated by Dennis Cooper	Five Years, London
	<i>Deutsche Show</i>	Divus Prager, Prague
	<i>Drawn From Photography</i>	The Drawing Center, NY
	<i>Breaking Ranks</i>	Headlands Center for the Arts, CA
	<i>Unpunished</i> , curated by Nayland Blake	Sue Scott Gallery, NY
2010	<i>The Pencil Show</i>	Foxy Production, NY
	<i>Hauntology</i>	Bereley Art Museum
	<i>Rabbit Taught the Eagle a Lesson</i>	Participant, NY
	<i>Lost Horizon</i>	Exile, Berlin
	<i>Paper Awesome</i>	Baer Ridgeway, SF
2009	<i>Zeigen</i>	Temporäre Kunsthalle, Berlin
	<i>First Service</i>	Schwules Museum, Berlin
	<i>Access All Areas</i>	Max Hetzler, Berlin
	<i>Galaxy</i>	Berkeley Art Museum
2008	<i>Passageworks</i>	SFMOMA
	<i>The Proof is in the Pudding</i>	Ratio 3, SF
	<i>Face Forward</i>	Leroy Neiman Gallery, NY
2007	<i>Freehand</i>	Arratia Beer, Berlin
	<i>Neolntegrity</i>	Derek Eller Gallery, NY
	<i>noh interior</i>	Durban Art Gallery, South Africa
	<i>Pussy Pussy Hello Hello</i>	Glue, Berlin

2006	<i>Memento Mori</i> <i>Summer Group Exhibition</i> <i>Twice Drawn</i> <i>Inaugural Exhibition</i>	Mireille Mosler Ltd., NY Derek Eller Gallery, NY Tang Museum, Saratoda Springs Derek Eller Gallery, NY
2005	<i>Looking at Words</i> <i>Drawing 1975–2005</i> <i>me myself and i</i>	Andrea Rosen Gallery, NY MoMA, NY gutleut 15, Frankfurt-Main
2004	<i>New Mural Projects</i> <i>Zeichnung</i> <i>Birdspace</i> <i>On Paper</i>	PPOW, NY NY Schwules Museum, Berlin CAC, New Orleans Nicole Klagsbrun, NY
2003	<i>Drawings</i> <i>20 Years 20 Artists</i> <i>Back in Black</i> <i>Queer Space</i>	Derek Eller Gallery, NY The LAB, SF Cohan Leslie & Browne, NY Boogie Woogie Kiosk, Dresden
2002	<i>die Schlotze [w/Gelatin]</i> <i>A Fine Line</i> <i>Landscape</i>	Festwochen Berlin New Jersey Center for Visual Arts Derek Eller Gallery, NY
2001	<i>Contemporary Utopia</i> <i>Fresh</i>	Arsenals Museum, Riga Latvia New Museum, NY
2000	<i>Made in California</i> <i>Bestiary</i> <i>Human/Nature</i> <i>Sightings</i> <i>Manley</i>	LA Contemporary Armory Center, Pasadena Caren Golden Fine Art, NY Bard College, Annandale NY Art in General, NY
1999	<i>Peek-a-Boo</i> <i>flower</i> (film screenings)	ESP, SF CA 48th Venice Biennale
1998	<i>Imaginary Friend</i> <i>Chicklet</i> <i>Agenda</i> <i>Pay-per-View</i> <i>El Campo</i>	Rupert Goldsworthy, NY John Begruen Gallery, SF Debs & Co., NY Caren Golden Fine Art, NY Berlin Bienale
1997	<i>Stuttered Landscape</i> <i>Works on Paper</i> <i>Scene of the Crime</i> <i>What I Was Wearing</i> <i>New Work: Drawings Today</i> <i>Selections Winter</i>	MIX Film Festival, NY Weatherspoon, Greensboro Armand Hammer Museum, LA YBCA, SF SFMOMA The Drawing Center, NY

PUBLISHED WORKS

2026	<i>Guarded View</i>	Fellow Travelers
	<i>Gentleman's Gentleman</i>	Thom Gunn, Edinburgh University Press
2025	<i>Cheater</i>	<i>Crooked Fagzine</i>
2024	<i>Union</i>	<i>Sluts, Dopamine</i>
2023	<i>Talking Stick</i>	<i>Impossible Voice</i>
2020	<i>Monstrous</i>	<i>Crooked Fagzine</i>
	<i>Mule</i>	<i>Panda's Friend</i>
2019	<i>Noteworthy</i>	<i>Impossible Voice</i>
2016	<i>Violets Have Broken the Rocks</i>	2nd floor projects
	<i>Jerome, the Earthquake</i>	#2
2015	<i>die Schlotze</i>	<i>Gelatin's ACB</i> , Walther König
	<i>Granted</i>	Sex Work
2014	<i>With Pleasure</i>	Musee d'art de Paris
2013	<i>The Light Always Fainter</i>	<i>Basso Magazine</i>
2012	<i>Western</i>	Tender Buttons
	<i>East Germany</i>	UOVO
2010	<i>Eye Caress</i>	Derek Eller Gallery
2008	<i>Total Eclipse</i> (w/Kevin Killian)	NLA
2006	<i>Nostalgic</i>	<i>Biting the Error</i>
	<i>The Fountain</i>	<i>Basso Magazine</i>
2003	<i>Friendly Fire</i>	<i>Stinging Fly</i>
2002	<i>Wounded Landscapes</i>	<i>Filmmaker Magazine</i>
1999	<i>Knot of Roads</i>	<i>Best Gay Erotica</i>
1996	<i>Scrapbook</i>	<i>Tricks and Treats</i>
	<i>(Mis)guided</i>	<i>Some Weird Sin</i>
	<i>Serious Edge</i>	Q-Think
1995	<i>Grappling Pines</i>	<i>Strange Fruit</i>
	<i>His Bride</i>	NLA
	<i>Dry Ice</i>	Dennis Cooper's <i>Discontents</i>

HONORS

2026	grant	The Bo Huston Prize (for literature)
2025	grant	Artiadia
2020	grant	COLA
2019	collection purchase	Houston LGBTQ Museum
2016	residency and grant	International Studio & Curatorial Program
2015	grant (top honor)	Artadia
	grant	James D. Phelan Award
2014	collection purchase	Berkeley Art Museum and PFA
2013	grant	Alternative Exposure
2012	commission	New Museum of Contemporary Art
	collection purchase	NY MoMA
2010	travel grant	CCA
2005	collection purchase	Weatherspoon
2001	grant and exhibition	Altoid Prize
2000	collection purchase	Contemporary Arts Museum Huston
1999	collection purchase	SFMOMA
1998	grant and exhibition	SECA Award (SFMOMA)
	collection purchase	Norton Foundation
1997	collection purchase	Whitney Museum of American Art
1996	residency	PACE